amfori
Trade with purpose

Rules of Procedure

April 2026



amfori
Speak for Change

amfori
Trade with purpose

Table of Contents

Chapter 1: Introduction 4

Chapter 2: General principles 5

2.1 Independence, legitimacy and fair conduct 5
2.2 Confidentiality and protection from retaliation 5
2.3 Transparency 6
2.4 Shared responsibility and collaboration 6
2.5 Complementary role 6
2.6 Rights-compatible outcomes 6
2.7 Focus on practical outcomes 6
2.8 Inclusive access, engagement and learning 6

Chapter 3: Governance 7

3.1 Role of amfori grievance mechanism experts 7
3.2 Role of members 7

Chapter 4: Scope 7

4.1 Who can submit a complaint? 8
4.2 Which complaints fall within scope? 8
4.3 Which complaints are outside scope? 8
4.4 Geographic scope 8

Chapter 5: Complaint submission and admissibility review 9

5.1 How to submit a complaint 9
5.2 Minimum information required 9
5.3 Additional information 9
5.4 Language and accessibility 9
5.5 Temporal connection and ability to act 9
5.6 Case reference and communication 10
5.7 Submission check and completeness review 10
5.8 Admissibility 10

Chapter 6: Case handling 11

6.1 Roles, responsibilities and decision-making 11
6.2 Main Stages of Case Handling 13

Process at a glance 13
6.2.1 Onboarding and initial coordination 13
6.2.2 Investigation and information gathering 13
6.2.3 Outcome assessment and remediation planning 13
6.2.4 implementation and monitoring 14
6.2.5 Closure and case status 14

6.3 Oversight by amfori during case handling 15
6.4 Escalation committee 15

Chapter 7: Appeal procedure 16

7.1 Who can appeal? 16
7.2 Grounds for appeal 16
7.3 How and when to submit an appeal? 16
7.4 Review and decision process 16
7.5 Possible appeal outcomes 16

Chapter 8: Transparency, reporting, and learning 17
8.1 Public transparency and accountability 17
8.2 Case-based communication 17
8.3 Internal evaluation and continuous improvement 17
Annex 1: Definitions and key terms 18

Chapter 1: Introduction

amfori Speak for Change is amfori's supply chain grievance mechanism. It offers an additional, non-judicial channel through which individuals, groups, and their legitimate representatives may raise concerns about potential human-rights, social or environmental impacts linked to amfori members and their suppliers. It complements, but does not replace, local or company-level grievance channels, which remain the first and most appropriate level for addressing grievances.

These Rules of Procedure explain how complaints are submitted, screened, handled, and closed through amfori Speak for Change. They set out the principles that guide the mechanism, the respective roles of amfori and members, and the main procedural steps that apply once a complaint falls within scope.

These Rules of Procedure should be read together with the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards, which set out the expected operating practices for amfori, members, and suppliers within this procedural framework.

amfori Speak for Change seeks to align with the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights and is informed by the OECD Due Diligence Guidance for Responsible Business Conduct. Through this mechanism, amfori supports its members in meeting their human rights due diligence responsibilities. Together with the Participation Standards, these Rules of Procedure form the publicly accessible framework of amfori Speak for Change. More detailed operational guidance may be set out in internal manuals and implementation tools.

Chapter 2: General principles

The amfori Speak for Change supply chain grievance mechanism is grounded in practical principles that guide how grievances are handled. These principles reflect the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights' effectiveness criteria for non-judicial grievance mechanisms, while translating them into operational expectations for complainants, members, suppliers, and other stakeholders. They describe how the mechanism seeks to support fair conduct, access to remedy, trust, accountability, and continuous improvement in practice.

2.1 Independence, legitimacy and fair conduct

To build trust in the mechanism, amfori Speak for Change is designed to support fair, impartial, and accountable handling of grievances.

amfori Speak for Change is designed to operate independently from undue influence, including from the commercial interests of amfori members and their suppliers, as well as from amfori's own institutional, operational, or reputational interests. Individuals involved in grievance handling are expected to act impartially. In practice, case-handling responsibilities should, where possible, be assigned to persons or functions with compliance, sustainability, human rights, or grievance management responsibilities, rather than to persons whose primary role is commercial sourcing, buying, supplier negotiation, or member relationship management.

A conflict of interest may arise, for example, where a person has direct commercial responsibility for the supplier concerned, where a linked member has an ownership interest or other corporate-control relationship with that supplier, or where a person involved in the case has a role that could reasonably affect impartial handling of the complaint.

Where a conflict of interest is identified or reasonably suspected, the relevant organisation should address it within its own decision making structure. amfori may also request or apply procedural safeguards within the amfori Speak for Change process, such as asking for another case contact, requiring additional oversight, limiting involvement in specific decisions, or escalating the matter through the applicable governance process. For more detailed operational expectations for members, see the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards.

2.2 Confidentiality and protection from retaliation

Personal data and case information are handled on a need-to-know basis and shared only where necessary for handling the case, in line with confidentiality and data-protection requirements. In practice, access to case information should be limited to those persons who need it to perform a defined role in intake, assessment, case handling, oversight, or remediation follow-up. Information should not be disclosed more widely than necessary, and identifying details may be restricted, anonymised, or withheld where this is needed to protect complainants or reduce the risk of retaliation.

Each case is also considered with attention to actual or potential retaliation risks. Where relevant, measures such as anonymised handling, delayed disclosure, limited information-sharing, or adapted communication arrangements may be used to reduce those risks. See also section 8.2.

2.3 Transparency

Complainants and members receive updates at key points in the process. Case progress is documented in the case management system, and anonymised aggregated information is published yearly to support accountability and trust without disclosing identifiable details.

2.4 Shared responsibility and collaboration

Where more than one amfori member is linked to a case, those members are expected to coordinate their response and work towards a consistent approach. The case management system supports collaboration by providing a shared case record, communication logs, and status updates.

Where the same matter is also being handled by another credible grievance mechanism, worker-representation process, or statutory process, amfori Speak for Change may take that process into account to avoid duplication and support effective handling of the complaint. This may include coordination, referral, or reliance on information already collected, where suitable for the case. Any sharing of personal data or case information must be limited to what is necessary and must comply with confidentiality, data-protection, and consent requirements.

2.5 Complementary role

amfori Speak for Change provides an additional route for raising concerns and does not replace effective local or company-level grievance channels. Depending on the circumstances, amfori may inform complainants about other appropriate support, referral, or grievance options.

2.6 Rights-compatible outcomes

amfori Speak for Change seeks to support outcomes and remedial steps that are consistent with internationally recognised human rights. In practice, this is embedded through the mechanism's scope, which is linked to the amfori BSCI Code of Conduct, and through the expectation that case handling should focus on addressing actual or potential harm in a way that is appropriate, proportionate, and consistent with responsible business conduct.

2.7 Focus on practical outcomes

The objective of each case is to achieve a timely and proportionate response to the issues raised. Depending on the facts, this may involve corrective action, changes in practices, protective measures, or other remedial steps. amfori Speak for Change continues to monitor case progress and may provide guidance and advice where appropriate.

Practical outcomes should be assessed not only by whether a case can be closed, but also by whether the response meaningfully addresses the issue raised and helps reduce the risk of recurrence.

2.8 Inclusive access, engagement and learning

The mechanism is intended to be accessible regardless of language, literacy level, disability, migration status, or access to technology. Special attention is given to barriers that could prevent meaningful participation, and reasonable adjustments may be made where needed. amfori Speak for Change also seeks to improve through feedback, case experience, stakeholder engagement, and dialogue where appropriate and safe. Lessons from cases and from the experience of users and stakeholders may be used to improve the mechanism, strengthen guidance, and help prevent future grievances or harms.

Chapter 3: Governance

amfori Speak for Change serves as the central intake and procedural oversight mechanism. amfori receives and screens complaints, maintains the procedural framework, administers the case management system, identifies and onboards linked members, and monitors case progression. Once a complaint is admitted, linked members remain responsible for leading case handling, including investigation, supplier engagement, complainant communication where needed through the agreed Speak for Change channel, remediation, monitoring, and closure. amfori's oversight role does not mean that amfori takes over case management or responsibility for case outcomes.

3.1 Role of amfori grievance mechanism experts

The amfori grievance mechanism experts are responsible for:

- reviewing new complaints submitted through the official amfori Speak for Change channels, including for completeness and admissibility, once they have entered the case management system, and requesting clarifications from complainants where needed;
- identifying linked members and onboarding them into the case management system;
- administering the case management system and case records, and ensuring information is captured into the broader amfori data ecosystem;
- providing process guidance, technical support, and subject-matter expertise;
- monitoring case progress, promoting consistency across cases, and flagging procedural issues;
- supporting procedural clarification where inactivity, conflicts of interest, disagreements, or other procedural issues put fair and timely case handling at risk; and
- coordinating escalation and appeal procedures under these Rules of Procedure; and

3.2 Role of members

Once a complaint is admitted and members are linked to the case, members are expected to review the case information, confirm whether they will participate in case handling, or explain why they believe they are not linked or will not engage.

Members that confirm participation become Engaged Members and support case handling in line with the role, leverage, expertise, resources, or budget they agree to bring to the case. Where more than one member is linked to a case, members are expected to identify a Lead Member to coordinate member-led case handling.

Members remain responsible for case handling after admission, including investigation, supplier engagement, complainant communication where needed and safe through the agreed Speak for Change channel, remediation, monitoring, and closure. amfori may provide procedural guidance, but this does not transfer case ownership or case-management responsibility to amfori.

Detailed practical expectations for linked members, Engaged Members and Lead Members, including baseline participation, Material Decisions, cost-sharing, and competition-law safeguards, are set out in the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards.

Chapter 4: Scope

This chapter sets out who may submit a complaint and the types of matters that fall within the scope of amfori Speak for Change.

4.1 Who can submit a complaint?

Complaints may be submitted by any individual, group, or legitimate representative that is or perceives itself to be negatively affected, by the actions or omissions of an amfori member or a linked supplier. This may include current or former workers, trade unions and worker associations, non-governmental and civil society organisations, community members, employers' organisations.

A complaint may be submitted directly by the affected person, through a legitimate representative, or anonymously, provided that enough information is available to allow for an admissibility review.

4.2 Which complaints fall within scope?

amfori Speak for Change handles complaints that concern alleged non-compliance with the amfori BSCI Code of Conduct, where the violation is attributed to an amfori member or to a supplier that has formally committed to the Code of Conduct and has a direct business link to an amfori member.

4.3 Which complaints are outside scope?

A complaint is outside the scope of amfori Speak for Change where, for example:

- there is no link to an active amfori member or to an active supplier linked to an amfori member;
- the issue is unrelated to the amfori BSCI Code of Conduct;
- the matter is purely commercial in nature, not indicative of direct or indirect human right risks;
- the complaint is abusive, knowingly false, defamatory, or submitted in bad faith; or
- the same matter has already received an outcome decision (e.g. non-grounded; remediated) via the amfori Speak for Change mechanism and no relevant new information is provided.

4.4 Geographic scope

The mechanism operates only in the countries and regions publicly listed on the amfori Speak for Change webpage at the time of submission. That published list is maintained by amfori and updated periodically to reflect where the mechanism is operationally available, including access channels, local language capacity, and case-handling support. Complaints arising outside that published geographic scope are not accepted under these Rules of Procedure.

Chapter 5: Complaint submission and admissibility review

This chapter explains how complaints are submitted and how amfori carries out the initial review before a case is handed over for member-led case handling.

5.1 How to submit a complaint

Complaints must be submitted through the official access channels published for amfori Speak for Change. These channels may include an online form, dedicated phone lines, or other official submission methods made available by amfori. Where a complaint is received through another route, the complainant may be asked to re-submit it through an official channel.

5.2 Minimum information required

To allow an admissibility review, a complaint should include, at a minimum:

- information that helps identify the supplier involved, such as the name, location, facility type, or other identifying details; and
- sufficiently detailed description of the issue, including what happened, where and when it occurred, who was affected or involved, and any relevant supporting context.

5.3 Additional information

Complainants may also provide supporting documents, indicate whether the complaint is being submitted on behalf of another person or group, describe previous attempts to resolve the issue, or explain any protection concerns. Such information is not always required, but it may help speed up the review.

5.4 Language and accessibility

Complaints may be submitted in English or in relevant local languages. Follow-up communication is conducted, as far as possible, in the complainant's preferred language. Communication methods and materials may be adapted to local contexts and accessibility needs.

5.5 Temporal connection and ability to act

Complaints should be submitted as soon as reasonably possible after the complainant becomes aware of the alleged harm. As a general guide, amfori Speak for Change normally handles complaints where the alleged facts occurred, continued, or became known to the complainant within 12 months before submission, and where there is a practical pathway for review, case handling, or remediation.

Older complaints may still be reviewed where the harm is ongoing, the complaint indicates a current pattern or risk affecting workers, the complainant was prevented from submitting earlier, new material information has become available, or the supplier and linked members still have a realistic ability to verify the facts and support remediation.

A complaint may be considered outside scope, or closed after preliminary review, where the facts are too old to be reasonably verified and no practical pathway to action remains. This does not affect any rights the complainant may have under applicable law or through other mechanisms.

5.6 Case reference and communication

After a complaint is submitted, the complainant receives an acknowledgement and, where technically available, a unique case reference or secure access credentials that can be used for follow-up communication. Anonymous complainants are expected to retain that reference to receive or retrieve later updates.

5.7 Submission check and completeness review

amfori grievance mechanism experts review each complaint to determine whether enough information is available to proceed. Where essential information is missing, amfori may request clarification through the available communication channel. If the available information remains insufficient to manage the case, the complaint may be closed as incomplete. The complainant may submit a new complaint later if additional information becomes available.

5.8 Admissibility

An admissibility decision is made within ten (10) business days after submission, based on the information available. In taking that decision, amfori considers whether the complaint falls within the scope described in Chapter 4 and whether it has a sufficient temporal connection and practical pathway for review under section 5.5.

Complaints that are already being handled by public authorities or courts will be declined where amfori's involvement would not add meaningful value to the handling of the matter.

If the complaint is admissible, the case is opened in the case management system, linked members are notified, and the matter proceeds to case handling. If the complaint is not accepted, the complainant receives an explanation and may, where appropriate, be invited to re-submit the complaint with additional information or be referred to another mechanism or support organisation.

Chapter 6: Case handling

Once a complaint is admitted, it enters the case-handling process. Linked members are onboarded into the case management system and are expected to take ownership of the case-handling process, individually or collectively. Throughout this process, amfori monitors progress and supports consistent implementation of the Rules of Procedure.

6.1 Roles, responsibilities and decision-making

Where more than one member is linked to a case, members are expected to review the case after onboarding and decide how they wish to participate. The initiative to start coordination sits with the linked members themselves. In practice, the first step is for one or more members to indicate through the case management system that they are willing to take the lead, or that they wish to discuss who is best placed to do so. Members are encouraged to identify a Lead Member within two weeks of onboarding, taking into account factors such as local presence, operational capacity, leverage, or a specific connection to the case.

Member coordination after onboarding: at a glance

This visual guide highlights the member actions and timelines once linked members have been onboarded into the case management system. Detailed expectations are set out in the text below and in the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards.

Step 1: Review and confirm **Timing:** *after onboarding* Review the case information, confirm the case contact and indicate participation in the case management system.	**Step 2: Identify Lead Member** **Timing:** *within 10 business days after notification in the CMS* Linked members agree who is best placed to coordinate, considering local presence, capacity, leverage or case connection.	**Step 3: Open coordination** **Timing:** *after Lead Member designation* The Lead Member proposes next steps, roles and immediate actions, including supplier engagement or information gathering.
Step 4: Handle and consult **Timing:** *during case handling* The Lead Member coordinates case handling and consults Engaged Members on material decisions such as costs, remediation or closure.	**Step 5: Respond to requests** **Timing:** *5 / 10 business days* Engaged Members acknowledge material requests within 5 business days and aim to provide a position within 10 business days.	**Step 6: Record or escalate** **Timing:** *ongoing* Updates, decisions and outreach are recorded in the case management system. Blocked ownership or unresolved disagreement may be escalated.

Note: Timelines are indicative procedural expectations. A different timeline may be set in the case record where the nature, urgency or complexity of the case requires it.

If no member volunteers to take the lead, the case management system sends automatic reminders to linked members. If no member takes ownership of the case after follow-up and reminders, amfori may inform the linked members that, in the absence of active participation, the case may need to be closed on procedural grounds. If more than one member wishes to take the lead, members may continue to collaborate closely in practice. Although one member is identified in the system as the Lead Member, both the Lead Member and Engaged Members may actively contribute to handling the case. Where two or more members wish to play a leading role in practice, they are expected to coordinate closely, use the platform chat function and other available coordination tools, and maintain a clear shared understanding of who is doing what.

The Lead Member serves as the main coordination point for the case. In practice, this means opening coordination with the linked members, leading contact with the supplier concerned, proposing the next case-handling steps, seeking and considering complainant input through the agreed amfori Speak for Change communication channel where this is possible and safe, and ensuring that key updates, evidence, decisions, outreach attempts, and any complainant feedback received are recorded in the case management system. The Lead Member may take routine coordination decisions to keep the case moving. Before moving forward on decisions that may affect other participating members, such as shared costs, remediation commitments,

closure position, or external communication of a joint view, the Lead Member is expected to consult the other participating members.

Examples of decisions that normally require consultation include the use of third-party support involving shared costs, agreement on a remediation approach requiring contributions from more than one member, the proposed closure position of the case, and external communications reflecting a joint member view. In urgent situations, the Lead Member may take interim coordination steps to protect complainants, reduce retaliation risk, preserve evidence, or avoid unnecessary delay. Where this happens, the reasons should be recorded in the case file and the other participating members should be informed as soon as possible.

Members that confirm participation in handling the case through the case management system are treated as Engaged Members. In practice, Engaged Members are expected to remain informed through the case management system, maintain an active contact point for the case, review key updates, and contribute the leverage, expertise, resources, or budget they have agreed to bring to the case. They are also expected to raise concerns, conflicts of interest, legal constraints, or practical limitations without undue delay. Members that do not confirm engagement are not treated as Engaged Members and would not normally be involved in shaping day-to-day case handling or decisions requiring active participation.

When the Lead Member seeks input on an important issue, it should share the proposed position through the case management system or another traceable coordination channel, explain what input is needed, and set a clear deadline for response. As a general guide, Engaged Members should acknowledge such requests within five business days and aim to provide their position within ten business days, unless the case record sets a different timeline. Silence should not normally be treated as agreement on an important issue. Where no response is received, the Lead Member should follow up, record the lack of response, and, if needed, seek amfori support to determine the next practical step. For routine coordination points, a no-objection approach may be used where the Lead Member has clearly framed the request in that way and set out the deadline in the case record.

Where Engaged Members have different views on an important issue, or where lack of response makes progress difficult, the Lead Member is expected to first seek a practical way forward through further coordination. This may include clarifying the issue in writing, organising a focused alignment exchange, narrowing the decision to the point actually in dispute, or asking members to confirm their position by a set date. If this does not resolve the issue, amfori may support clarification, help the members identify next steps, or, in more complex or sensitive situations, consider escalation in line with the applicable amfori Speak for Change governance process. As a general principle, disagreement between members should not by itself bring case handling to an end. The focus should remain on identifying a workable path forward. Where no member takes active ownership of the case despite reminders and follow-up, procedural closure may need to be considered.

The amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards complement this section by providing more detailed guidance on how Lead Members and Engaged Members are expected to work together in practice, including participation, cost-sharing, and competition-law safeguards.

6.2 Main Stages of Case Handling

The main stages of case handling are set out below.

Process at a glance

1	2	3	4	5
Onboarding and Lead Member designation	Investigation and/or information gathering	Outcome assessment and remediation planning	Implementation and monitoring	Closure

6.2.1 Onboarding and initial coordination

Linked members are identified based on linkage information recorded in amfori Sustainability Platform. It is the amfori member's sole responsibility to keep their supply chain linkages up to date on the amfori Sustainability Platform. Related governance expectations regarding data quality, designated contacts, and participation readiness are further set out in the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards.

During onboarding, linked members are provided access to the complaint details, supporting case documents, and communication history in the case management system. Once onboarded, the involved members are expected to confirm their participation and designate a Lead Member.

The supplier is informed at the appropriate stage of the process, considering confidentiality, safety, and the information needed to handle the case effectively. Once informed, the supplier is expected to cooperate in good faith with investigation, remediation, and follow-up steps.

6.2.2 Investigation and information gathering

The Lead Member applies a proportionate approach to investigation. In some cases, direct engagement with the supplier and review of existing documents or audit evidence may be sufficient to clarify the facts. In more sensitive, disputed, or complex matters, the Lead Member may rely on an independent third-party investigator or another appropriate fact-finding approach.

Where a third-party investigation is used, the Lead Member may appoint a suitable provider, including from any amfori-approved list where such a list exists. Investigation timelines vary depending on the nature and complexity of the grievance and may extend over several weeks or longer.

Where another credible grievance mechanism, worker-representation process, or statutory process is already addressing the same matter, the Lead Member may take this into account when defining the fact-finding approach, in line with section 2.5. Any reliance on information from another process should be recorded in the case file.

Where necessary and safe, additional clarifications may also be sought from the complainant during this stage, including where identity disclosure, further factual detail, or follow-up information is required.

6.2.3 Outcome assessment and remediation planning

Based on the available evidence, the Lead Member assesses whether the complaint is grounded, partially grounded, not grounded, or whether no conclusion is possible. The Lead Member records the proposed outcome in the case management system and informs Engaged Members through the system workflow.

Where a complaint is grounded or partially grounded, the Lead Member develops a remediation plan with the supplier and, where needed, with Engaged Members, external experts, worker representatives, or service

providers involved in implementing the plan. The remediation plan should set out the proposed actions, responsibilities, expected timeline, monitoring arrangements, measures to reduce retaliation risks, and any resource or budget assumptions.

Where the complainant is directly impacted or otherwise personally involved in the matter, the remediation plan should, where possible and safe, be informed by the complainant's views. This means that the complainant should be given an opportunity to comment on the proposed remediation approach, especially where their input is needed to assess whether the proposed outcome would be meaningful in practice. This does not mean that complainant agreement is required before the case can move forward. If the complainant does not respond, cannot be reached, or does not wish to engage further, remediation planning may continue based on the available information, provided that reasonable outreach attempts are recorded in the case file.

Where possible and safe, the complainant should be informed of the proposed remediation plan, the expected duration of the process, and any key steps that directly affect them. Information shared with the complainant may be adapted where needed to protect confidentiality, prevent retaliation, or respect legal or personal-data restrictions.

Where a complaint is not grounded, or where no conclusion is possible, the case may be closed with a reasoned explanation. Depending on the circumstances, preventive or improvement measures may still be recommended.

Where remediation planning requires shared budget commitments, cost-sharing, or external support, participating members should follow the amfori Speak for Change Participation Standards.

6.2.4 implementation and monitoring

Implementation may be led directly by the Lead Member in engagement with the supplier or supported by a third party, depending on what is appropriate for the case. The Lead Member remains responsible for ensuring that agreed actions are documented and that evidence of implementation is collected.

amfori grievance mechanism experts monitor case progress through the case management system and may provide guidance where there are procedural issues, inactivity, conflicts of interest, or disagreements that put fair and timely case handling at risk. Updates are communicated to complainants where possible and safe to do so.

6.2.5 Closure and case status

A case is closed when there is a documented basis to do so and the complainant has been informed where possible and safe. If the complainant cannot be reached or remains anonymous, the case may still be closed provided that the actions taken or the rationale for closure are clearly documented.

At closure, the case is recorded under one of the following statuses:

- Remediated: the agreed preventive, corrective or remedial actions have been substantially implemented and the key issues raised by the complaint have been addressed;
- Partially remediated: some issues have been addressed, while other actions remain outstanding or require further follow-up;
- Not remediated: no adequate preventive, corrective or remedial action was implemented, the process was blocked, or participating actors disengaged before completion;
- Closed – not grounded: the investigation did not substantiate the complaint; or
- Closed – no conclusion possible: the available information did not allow a reliable conclusion to be reached.

6.3 Oversight by amfori during case handling

During case handling, amfori grievance mechanism experts maintain procedural and platform governance oversight. They do not replace members in handling the case, but they may intervene to address inactivity, procedural non-compliance, conflicts of interest, or disagreements between members about how the case is being handled.

Where appropriate, amfori may issue process guidance or expert recommendations to support consistent treatment of the case and to help determine whether further action is required before closure.

6.4 Escalation committee

In particularly complex, sensitive, or disputed cases, amfori may consult an internal Escalation Committee. Its role is to provide internal advice where a case involves heightened risks, systemic or procedural integrity concerns.

The composition of the Escalation Committee may vary according to the matter at hand and may include amfori staff or leadership representatives from departments relevant to the nature of the escalation..

Chapter 7: Appeal procedure

amfori Speak for Change provides an appeal process to help ensure procedural fairness, accountability, and trust in the mechanism.

7.1 Who can appeal?

An appeal may be submitted by the original complainant, an amfori member directly involved in the case, or a supplier engaged in the case. Appeals submitted by a representative on behalf of another person or organisation must include an explanation of that representation and may require supporting confirmation.

7.2 Grounds for appeal

An appeal must be based on one or more of the following grounds:

- a procedural error that may have affected the handling or outcome of the case;
- new evidence that was not reasonably available at the time of the original review;
- a substantiated concern about bias or conflict of interest; or
- a material misapplication of these Rules of Procedure.

Disagreement with the outcome on its own is not a sufficient ground for appeal and will lead to inadmissibility of the appeal.

7.3 How and when to submit an appeal?

Appeals must be submitted by email to speakforchange@amfori.org. The appeal should be submitted within fifteen (15) business days from the day of case outcome communication on the case management system. Extensions may be granted where the appealing party provides a valid justification, such as language barriers or unforeseen circumstances.

The appeal should clearly state the ground or grounds relied on and include any new evidence or supporting information. Appeals shall be submitted preferably in English or in the appellant's native language.

7.4 Review and decision process

Receipt of an appeal is acknowledged within three (3) business days. The review is carried out by an amfori staff member, or where appropriate an external expert, who had no prior involvement in the original handling of the case.

The review is limited to the procedural issue, new evidence, or other ground raised in the appeal. A final written decision is issued within fifteen (15) business days after receipt of a complete appeal and explains the findings and the resulting determination.

7.5 Possible appeal outcomes

- Appeal accepted – case reopened, in full or in part;
- Appeal accepted – original outcome or remediation approach modified;
- Appeal rejected – original decision upheld; or
- Appeal inadmissible – the appeal does not meet the requirements set out in this Chapter.

Chapter 8: Transparency, reporting, and learning

amfori Speak for Change is committed to transparency, confidentiality and continuous improvement.

8.1 Public transparency and accountability

amfori publishes anonymised information about the mechanism and its use, including through periodic public reporting. Such reporting may include data such as the number and general type of complaints received, overall case outcomes, recurring themes, regional patterns, and examples of good practice where appropriate and sufficiently anonymised.

No personal data, facility identifiers, or other traceable details are disclosed in public reporting.

8.2 Case-based communication

During and after a case, communication is tailored to the role of the relevant parties, taking into account confidentiality and protection considerations. Case-based information is shared only with parties directly involved in the case and only to the extent necessary for them to fulfil their respective roles. The complainant is informed of key milestones and of the outcome of the case. Information is shared in a manner that is appropriate, proportionate, and only insofar as it does not create risks of retaliation or breach of confidentiality obligations.

In exceptional circumstances, amfori may share anonymised case-based information with external parties, such as other grievance mechanisms or initiatives, where this supports the interests or protection of the complainant and does not increase risks of harm or retaliation.

8.3 Internal evaluation and continuous improvement

amfori regularly reviews case outcomes, member engagement, and supplier responsiveness in order to identify recurring issues, assess the effectiveness of investigation and remediation approaches, and improve training, documentation, and implementation tools.

Lessons from grievances may be used to strengthen amfori's grievance procedures, the amfori BSCI approach to due diligence, member guidance on stakeholder engagement, and supplier engagement or training approaches. Where systemic risks are identified, amfori may recommend further escalation, propose coordinated action, or trigger other measures available under the wider amfori framework.

Annex 1: Definitions and key terms

This annex explains selected terms used in these Rules of Procedure in plain language. It is intended to make the document easier to use for readers who are not familiar with amfori terminology.

Term	Explanation
amfori Speak for Change	amfori's supply chain grievance mechanism: an additional, non-judicial channel through which concerns about potential negative social or environmental impacts can be raised.
Rules of Procedure	This document. It explains how complaints are submitted, reviewed, handled, and closed through amfori Speak for Change.
Complainant	The person, group, or legitimate representative that submits a complaint or on whose behalf a complaint is submitted.
Legitimate representative	A person or organisation that is authorised or reasonably positioned to raise a complaint on behalf of affected people.
amfori member	A company that is a member of amfori and that may be linked to a complaint through its business relationships.
Supplier	The facility, employer, producer, or other supplier linked to an amfori member and relevant to the complaint.
Linked member	Registered buying company (such as a brand or retailer) officially connected to a specific supplier's profile on the amfori Sustainability Platform, allowing them to access and share that supplier's sustainability data and audit results.
Lead Member	The Lead Member is designated to coordinate case handling when more than one member is involved in the same case.
Engaged Member	A linked member that confirms participation in the case and is expected to review key updates, contribute where relevant, and take part in material decisions.
Admissibility review	amfori's initial review to decide whether a complaint contains enough information and falls within the scope of the mechanism. In case of an appeal, the admissibility review concerns the matters mentioned under Chapter 7: who can appeal, grounds for appeal, how and when to submit an appeal.
Case management system	The digital platform used to register cases, store documents, share updates, and support coordination between amfori and members.
Investigation / fact-finding	The process of gathering and assessing information in order to understand what happened and determine the appropriate case outcome.
Remediation	Actions taken to address harm or risk identified through a case. This may include corrective, preventive, protective, or follow-up measures.
Retaliation	Any threat, punishment, intimidation, discrimination, or other adverse action linked to raising, supporting, or participating in a complaint.
Participation Standards	The amfori rules that govern how members participate in the mechanism, including any relevant expectations on cooperation, resources, or cost-sharing.
amfori BSCI Code of Conduct	The amfori standard used in these Rules of Procedure to assess whether a complaint falls within scope.
Escalation Committee	An internal amfori group that may be consulted in particularly complex, sensitive, or disputed cases.
Appeal	A request to review an outcome or process on one or more of the specific grounds set out in Chapter 7 of these Rules of Procedure.
Outcome status	The case classification recorded at closure, such as remediated, partially remediated, not remediated, not grounded, or no conclusion possible.

amfori
Trade with purpose



Amfori
Avenue de Tervueren 270
1150 Brussels, Belgium
T +32 (0)2 741 64 76
E info@amfori.org

amfori.org